Teardown #3

Interview context

After interviewing gym-goer Z, I chose Nike Training Club for a hands-on teardown. Z uses the app about two to three hours a week and watched its split squat demonstration a couple of times, but still was not sure whether their own form was correct.

Device note: Several apps that offer camera-based form feedback are currently available only on Apple devices. Because I use an Android phone and a non-Apple laptop, I could not test those apps, and a browser-based alternative was unavailable at the time of review. I chose Nike Training Club because it is available on Android and is the app Z uses.

My Nike Training Club teardown

Searching for the exercise

I typed “split squat” into the search bar, the way Z described finding it. The results did not show anything I could see labeled split squat. Instead, they listed full workouts such as 60-Min Full Court Strength & Power, 45-Min Power for Runners, and 45-Min Strength & Stability for Runners.

Workout page

I opened 60-Min Full Court Strength & Power. The page had a Start Workout button and a list of timed exercises, such as 30 seconds of deadbug floor slides, a 30-second hip lift hold, 20 seconds of isometric split squats on each side, and 20 seconds of pogo jumps. This screen did not show videos or explain how to do each exercise, and I did not know what some of them were, such as deadbug floor slides.

Drill videos

Selecting View drills showed the demonstration videos, which ranged from about 9 to 24 seconds. The camera used a three-quarter or side view. Some demonstrators were not centered in the frame, and in the pogo jump video the demonstrator was quite far from the camera. Most of the demonstrators were men.

Checking my own form

Because each video showed only one angle, I could not see the movement from other views or what the other side looked like. I could not tell whether my own position was right, and the app did not give any feedback on my movement.

Points of hesitation

- **Search:** Searching for a specific exercise returned full workouts instead of that exercise.
- **Hidden demonstrations:** Videos were only available under View drills, not on the main workout page.
- **Unexplained names:** Some exercise names were unfamiliar and were not explained on the workout page.
- **Camera framing:** Videos used one three-quarter or side view, and some demonstrators were off-center or far from the camera.
- **Representation:** Most demonstrators were men; users may benefit from a wider range of demonstrators.
- **No feedback:** The app did not show whether my own form was correct.

Strengths, gaps, and Formly implication

Strengths: Nike Training Club organizes exercises into structured, timed workouts, and short drill videos are available for each exercise once you find them.

Gaps: Finding a specific exercise took extra steps, demonstrations were tucked behind View drills, each video showed only one angle, and I did not observe the app assessing my own form.

Connection to Interview Z: My experience matched Z’s. The app helps organize workouts, but after watching the demonstration I was still unsure whether my form was right.

Formly implication: It may be worth testing whether users benefit from searchable exercise demonstrations, multiple camera angles, clearer framing, and a wider range of demonstrators, alongside feedback on their own movement. These are ideas to investigate, not findings about what users need.